

WANTIAN HUANG

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PLACEMENT DIRECTORS

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EDUCATION

Ph.D.	Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, expected May 2027
M.A.	Economics, Columbia University, 2020
B.S.	Economics and Mathematics, University of California San Diego, 2018

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Primary:	Industrial Organization
Secondary:	Applied Econometrics

DISSERTATION

Essays in Empirical Industrial Organization

Committee: Prof. Chenyu Yang (Chair), Prof. Andrew Sweeting, Prof. Ying Fan (University of Michigan)

JOB MARKET PAPER

“Testing the Substitution Predictions of Demand Models: Evidence from the Blue Bell Recall”

Demand models’ substitution predictions inform merger review and the value of product variety. Using the 2015 withdrawal of the regional ice cream brand Blue Bell, I test how well models estimated on data through March 2015 predict the amount of demand retained by rivals and its allocation among them. Relative to markets Blue Bell never served, rivals recaptured about three quarters of its volume, and private label took half of that gain. Logit and random-coefficient models without nesting retain too little demand. A nested logit that pools private label with Blue Bell’s mainstream tubs comes close both on how much demand stays with rivals and on which rivals receive it, and random-coefficient nested logit (RCNL), which allows consumer heterogeneity on the same nests, performs similarly. In this application, where private label sits in the nests matters more for these predictions than how much taste heterogeneity a model allows.

OTHER RESEARCH

“Economies of Scope in Retail Distribution: A Study of Ready-to-Consume Categories,” working paper, with Ying Fan, Yidan Xu, and Chenyu Yang

“Evaluating the Welfare Impacts of EV Charging Station Subsidies: An Analysis of the NEVI Program in Texas,” working paper

“Quality Uncertainty, Learning, and Product Variety in Live Streaming Platforms”, in progress

RESEARCH AND RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

Economist Intern, Amazon Ads Marketing Finance, Seattle, WA, Summer 2026

Research Assistant, Prof. Chenyu Yang, University of Maryland, Summer 2024 and Summer 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor (Undergraduate, University of Maryland)

Economics of Regulation and Antitrust, Summer 2024

Teaching Assistant Representative, M.S. in Applied Economics Program, 2026

Teaching Assistant (M.S., University of Maryland)

Information, Game Theory and Market Design, Springs 2024–2025, Fall 2026

Microeconomic Analysis, Spring 2024, Fall 2026

Financial Economics, Springs 2023, 2025, and 2026

Program Analysis and Evaluation, Winters 2022 and 2024–2026

Topics in Applied Macroeconomics, Winter 2026

Environmental Economics, Winters 2022–2025

Economic Development, Spring 2023

Economic Analysis of Law, Spring 2022

International Trade and Applications, Winter 2022

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026: Industrial Organization Workshop, University of Maryland (scheduled, October)

LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent)

COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

Python (pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, EconML), SQL (Redshift, Hive, Spark), Stata, MATLAB, LaTeX; HPC (SLURM)

REFERENCES

Prof. Chenyu Yang	University of Maryland	cyang111@umd.edu	(301) 405-3512
Prof. Andrew Sweeting	University of Maryland	atsweet@umd.edu	(301) 405-8325
Prof. Ying Fan	University of Michigan	yingfan@umich.edu	(734) 763-3096